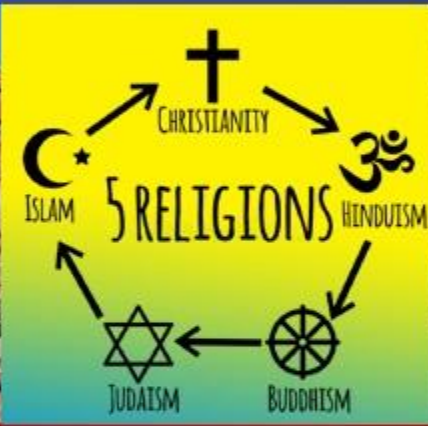


ART & CULTURE



INDIAN ARCHITECTURE

MODULE - 16

ROCK-CUT ARCHITECTURE

- ELLORA CAVES
- PREVIOUS YEARS QUESTIONS

ROCK-CUT ARCHITECTURE

2

ELLORA CAVES



1 This group of caves near Aurangabad is another UNESCO World Heritage site and is said to be an epitome of rock-cut architecture.

2 These caves were built between 5th century CE to 11th century CE under the patronage of different dynasties, primarily, the Rashtrakutas, Chalukyas and Yadavas.

ROCK-CUT ARCHITECTURE

2

ELLORA CAVES



3

These cave sculptures are a confluence of Buddhist, Brahmanical, and Jain subjects.

4

Besides, they represent different styles of architecture and craftsmanship as guilds from Tamilnadu, Karnataka, Vidarbha, etc. carved different caves at different points of time.

5

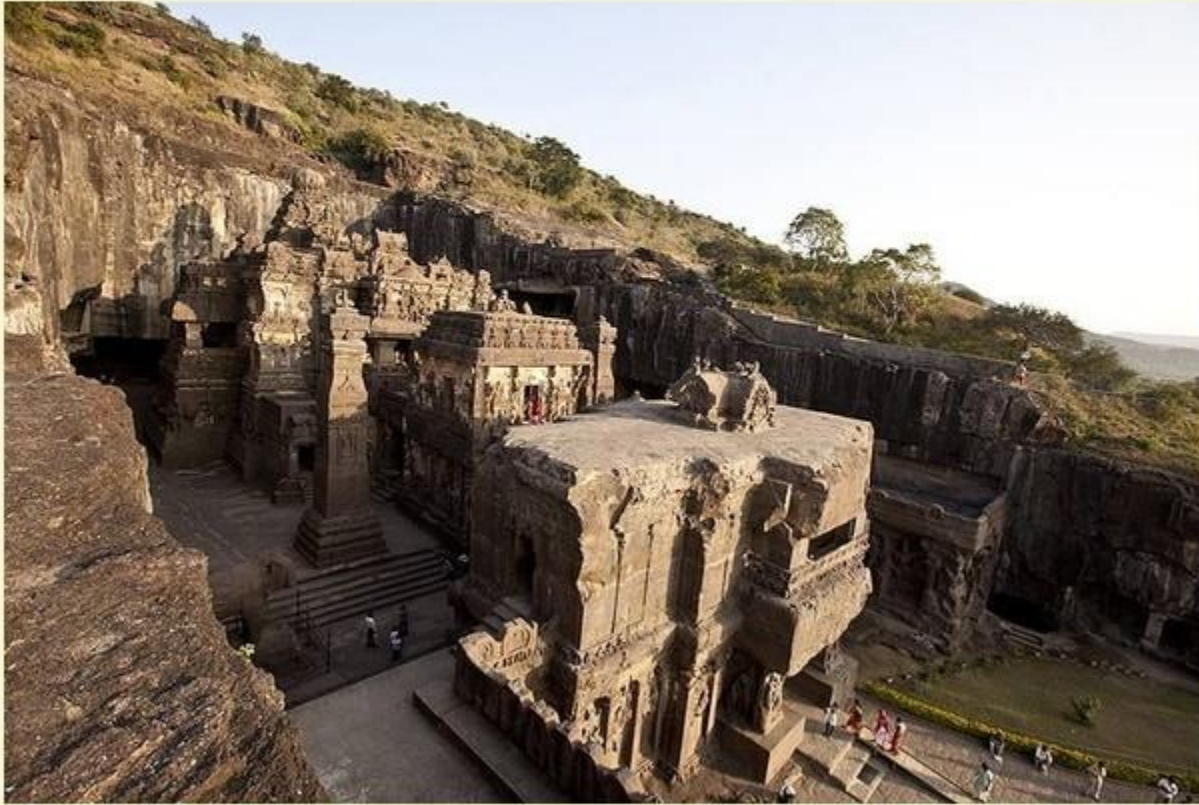
Many caves are two storeys and some even three storeys which adds to the uniqueness of Ellora.

ROCK-CUT ARCHITECTURE

2

ELLORA CAVES

DIFFERENCE B/W AJANTA & ELLORA



ROCK-CUT ARCHITECTURE

2

ELLORA CAVES

6 The **17 Hindu** (caves 13–29, Caves No. 14 and 15 are famous and are known as ‘Ravan Ki Khai’ and ‘Dasavatar caves’ respectively), **12 Buddhist** (caves 1–12) and **5 Jain** (caves 30–34, Jaina caves include ‘Indra Sabha’ and ‘Jagannath Sabha’) caves, built in proximity, demonstrate the religious harmony prevalent during this period of Indian history.

7 **Kailasa Temple** – Cave 16 in Ellora is the **largest single monolithic excavation** in the world.

8 Some of the prominent caves in Ellora are:

- Cave no 10 is a chaitya cave dedicated to **Vishwakarma**
- Cave 14 is themed “**Raavan ki khai**”
- Cave 15 is **Dashavathar caves**
- Cave 16 is **Kailash temple**. It was developed under the patronage of Rashtrakutas and carved out of a monolith .
- Two famous Jain caves are **Indra Sabha and Jagannath Sabha**.

ROCK-CUT ARCHITECTURE

2

ELLORA CAVES



Cave 14- Raavan ki Khai



Cave 15- The Dashavatara

ROCK-CUT ARCHITECTURE

2

ELLORA CAVES



Numerous tantric Buddhist goddesses are carved in Ellora Cave 12.

9 The Buddhist caves contain the images of Buddha who is guarded by Vajrapani and Padmapani.

10 Many images of Tara and Bodhisattvas like Amitabha, Avlokiteshwara, Vairochana, etc. are found.

11 The Jain caves are known for their decorative and ornate images. These are of later period (9th century CE).

ROCK-CUT ARCHITECTURE

2

ELLORA CAVES

- 12** The Brahmanical caves are of **Shaivism faith** (image of Gajasura Shiva in cave no. 15) besides the image of different avataras of Vishnu are also found in the form of **Dashavatara images** (cave no. 15).



Figure represents
Gajasura Shiva

MAN'S WORK
OR
GOD'S WORK?



ROCK-CUT ARCHITECTURE

2

ELLORA CAVES



Kailash temple of Ellora

13 The most famous creation at Ellora is the greatest Kailasa temple (cave no. 16) which is carved out of a single piece of rock. Thus, it is the largest monolithic temple which even included a courtyard.

14 The temple is dedicated to Lord Shiva. The temple's central shrine has a lingam with a roofed 'mandapa' supported by 16 pillars and a shikhara of Dravidian style. An image of Nandi (bull) is seen in the porch in front of the temple.

ROCK-CUT ARCHITECTURE

2

ELLORA CAVES

KAILASA TEMPLE



1 The Kailash Temple, dedicated to Shiva, is considered to be a magnificent achievement of the ancient Hindus, and represents Shiva's celestial abode, Mt. Kailasa.

2 It was executed under the patronage of the Rashtrakuta King, Krishna I.

3 It is one of the grandest monolithic excavations in the world.

4 The architects worked from above downwards, until they struck one gigantic solid rock which they shaped into a temple.

ROCK-CUT ARCHITECTURE

2

ELLORA CAVES

KAILASA TEMPLE



Carved elephants in the entrance

5

The hillside was cut down to the level of the base of the hill and it has been estimated that 3 million cubic feet of rock were chiselled out.

6

The remarkable imagination which conceived it, the unstinted period of a hundred years and finally, the sculpture with which it is adorned have been aptly summed by Percy Brown: “This decoration is.....something more than a record of artistic form, it is great spiritual achievement, each portion being a rich statement glowing with meaning.”

7

Kailasa stands in the middle of a vast court in which are carved colossal elephants and other animals.

ROCK-CUT ARCHITECTURE

2

ELLORA CAVES

KAILASA TEMPLE



Carved images of elephants in the plinth of the temple

8

The main temple is dedicated to Shiva. The temple proper stands on a plinth and has an impressive frieze of boldly carved elephants and lions.

9

The temple is approached by flights of steps and is double-storeyed with chapels and monastic halls hewn out of the rock.

10

The interior consists of a pillared hall with a cruciform central aisle.

ROCK-CUT ARCHITECTURE

2

ELLORA CAVES

KAILASA TEMPLE



Ramayana friezes on the wall

11 The friezes on the wall have scenes from the Ramayana executed with superb artistry and craftsmanship.

12 The pavilion has Shiva's bull, Nandi, in front. The two pillars on either side of the Nandi shrine are called Dhvajastambhas (Flag-staffs)

13 They have symbolic carvings pertaining to the cult of Shiva and are fine works of art.



Main temple (right) connected by rock bridge to the Nandi Pavilion; in front of the pavilion is one of the two Dhvajastambhas,

ROCK-CUT ARCHITECTURE

2

ELLORA CAVES

INDRA SABHA & JAGANNATH SABHA



Figure of Indra in Indra Sabha

1

In the final group of five Ellora caves (the Jain Group), the most interesting are the **Indra Sabha** (assembly hall of Indra, king of the gods) and **Jagannath Sabha** (Assembly hall of the lord of the Universe).

2

The Indra Sabha is a **two storeyed shrine** cut into the rock to a depth of over 200 feet and is approached through a rock-hewn doorway leading into a square courtyard.

ROCK-CUT ARCHITECTURE

2

ELLORA CAVES

INDRA SABHA & JAGANNATH SABHA



**Mahavira with yaksha
Matanga and yakshi Siddhaiki**

3

To the right is an imposing statue of an elephant. The Jagannath Sabha is similar in plan to the Indra Sabha but smaller.

4

The shrine is a small chamber with a well-proportioned torana (Arch), and **within it is seated Mahavira.**

5

The walls are recessed for figured sculptures, and **the pillars are richly carved in the best Jain traditions.**

ROCK-CUT ARCHITECTURE

2

ELLORA CAVES

INDRA SABHA & JAGANNATH SABHA



Carvings on the pillars of the Jagannatha Sabha

- 6 The upper storey is borne on 12 profusely sculptured pillars and these and the broad surface dividing the two storeys are profusely carved, the upper one having images of the 24 Jain Tirthankaras.
- 7 The ceiling over the large altar is in the form of a large lotus. At each end of the hall is a large shrine containing a statue of Mahavira. This temple is possibly the earliest of the Jain group.
- 8 On the top of the hill in which the Jain Caves are excavated is a rock-hewn statue of Parasnath.

PRELIMS 2013

With reference to the history of Indian rock-cut architecture, consider the following statements:

1. The caves at Badami are the oldest surviving rock-cut caves in India.
2. The Barabar rock-cut caves were originally made for Ajivikas by Emperor Chandragupta Maurya.
3. At Ellora, caves were made for different faiths.

Which of the above is / are correct?

- | | |
|-----------|---------------------|
| a) 1 only | b) 2 & 3 |
| c) 3 only | d) All of the Above |

Answer: C

PRELIMS 2013

What is/are common to the two historical places known as Ajanta and Mahabalipuram?

1. Both were built in the same period
2. Both belong to the same religious denomination.
3. Both have rock-cut monuments.

Which of the above is / are correct?

- | | |
|---------------|----------------------|
| a) 1 & 2 only | b) 3 only |
| c) 1 & 3 only | d) None of the Above |

Answer: B

PRELIMS 2013

Consider the following historical places:

1. Ajanta Caves
2. Lepakshi Temple
3. Sanchi Stupa



Learning Space

Which of the above is / are known for mural paintings?

- | | |
|---------------|----------------------|
| a) 1 only | b) All 1, 2 & 3 |
| c) 1 & 2 only | d) None of the Above |

Answer: C

I

INDIAN ARCHITECTURE AND SCULPTURE

- 1 INDUS VALLEY CIVILISATION
- 2 MAURYAN PERIOD
- 3 POST MAURYAN PERIOD
- 4 GUPTA PERIOD
- 5 TEMPLE ARCHITECTURE
- 6 INDO-ISLAMIC SCHOOL
- 7 COLONIAL ARCHITECTURE

II

INDIAN PAINTINGS

III

INDIAN MUSIC

- 1 VARIOUS CLASSIFICATION OF INDIAN MUSIC
- 2 MUSICAL INSTRUMENTS

IV

INDIAN DANCE FORMS

- 1 CLASSICAL DANCES
- 2 FOLK DANCES

V

INDIAN LITERATURE

- 1 ANCIENT PERIOD
- 2 MEDIEVAL PERIOD
- 3 MODERN PERIOD

COURSE OUTLINE

- VI INDIAN RELIGIONS
- VII SCHOOLS OF PHILOSOPHY
- VIII INDIAN THEATRE
- IX CULTURAL INSTITUTIONS IN INDIA
- X MARTIAL ART IN INDIA
- XI INDIAN PUPPETRY

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